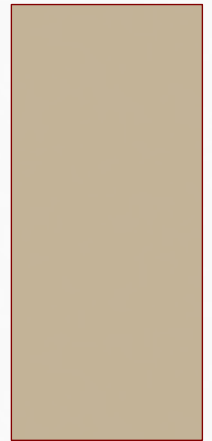


STARTING YOUR GAME DESIGN

ADVANCED GAME DESIGN & DEVELOPMENT

DANNY JUGAN



GAMES IN A 3D WORLD

- Certain game genres are better suited for 3D environments.
- For your course project, you aren't required to make an adventure or RPG, but you should choose a game that utilizes the benefits that come with having a 3D environment.
- Your game should not simply be a 2D game in a 3D environment.

WHERE DO I START

- So you have an idea for a game... or maybe you don't...
- What are the first things that need to be considered when designing a game?
 - **Genre** (Adventure, Sports, etc.)
 - **Style** (Medieval, Futuristic, Modern, etc.)
 - **Core Mechanics** (What is the player doing?)
 - **Fun Features** (What will keep the player playing?)
- For now, jot down your ideas. You will formalize them later in your Game Design Document (GDD).

THE ADVENTURE GENRE

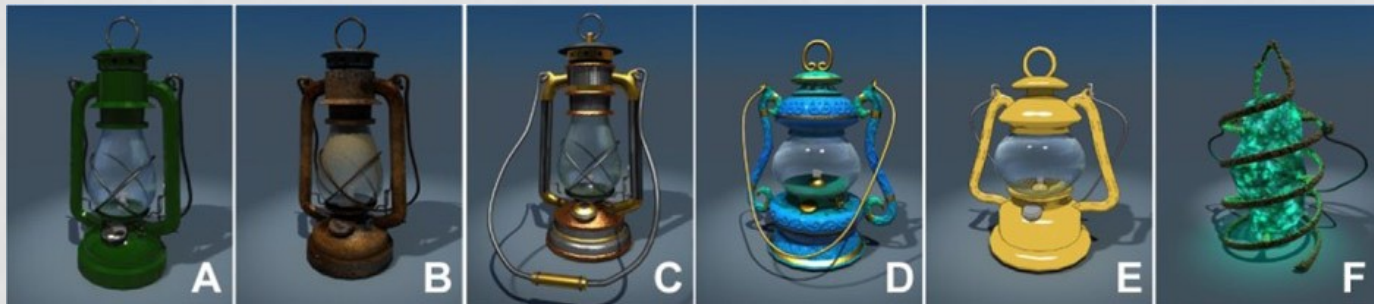
- There is some subjectivity and differing of opinion with how games are categorized. For the purpose of this class, we'll use a broad view of what is labeled as an Adventure Game.
- The Adventure Genre spans across a wide variety of games.
 - RPGs, Puzzle Games, Stealth Games, etc.
- Any game where you can **explore** and/or **interact** with an environment that isn't entirely visible at once.

YOUR PROJECT

- While we will discuss game design principles that are universally applicable, most will be directly related/specific to adventure-type games.
- Again - your project does not have to be an adventure game, but it must utilize a 3D environment.
- We will discuss the specific requirements for your project later.

STYLE

- Once you select your genre, you'll need to decide on a style.
- Let's say you wanted to create an exploration game that will utilize lanterns. What style to use?



- How many different RPG styles can you name?

CORE MECHANICS

- The core mechanics of a game are the tasks that the player will continually do in order to succeed.
- What are the core mechanics of these games?
 - Mario?
 - Zelda?
 - Madden?

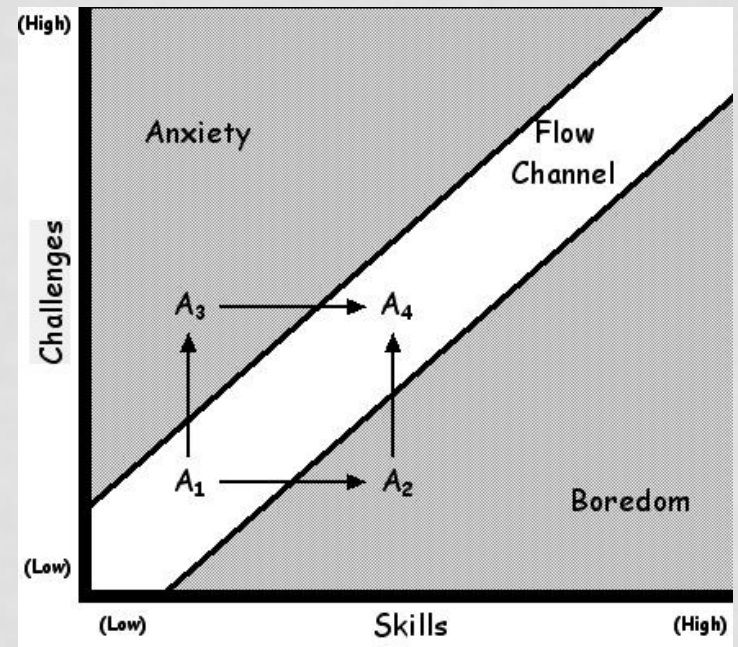


FUN FEATURES

- Here's the tough part...
- You've established what your game will look like and what the player will be doing, but why would they want to play your game?
- This begs the all-important (and much debated) game design question: **What makes games fun?**
- There are certainly some generic principles to fun, but there are also genre-specific factors to explore.

GENERIC FUN FEATURES

- There must be a balance between the skill of the player and the challenge level of the game.
- Too easy = boredom
- Too hard = frustration
- A game's difficulty should match a player's skill level.



GENERIC FUN FEATURES

- What are other generic features of games that make them fun?
- Have you ever played a game that had a feature/mechanic that made you want to turn the game off?



ADVENTURE SPECIFIC FUN FEATURES

- Suspension of Consequences
- Intellectual Stimulus
- Visual Engagement
- Storyline
- Collecting stuff
- New experiences



A COUPLE OF TIPS

- Keep it simple. More is not always better.
- Don't bite off more than you can chew (i.e., RPGs)
- Focus first on the mechanics and features that will make the game fun.
- Plan your game in tiers so that you don't waste your time with extra stuff and get caught with scope creep.
- Write everything down – even if it's messy.